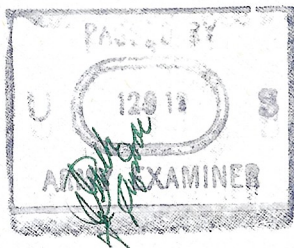


PT. O.T. HOFFSTETER JR.
3746383 MAINT. DIV.
12th MOB. LER. REGT. P.O.
6 PM N.Y.C.



VIA AIR MAIL



MISS MARY DARROUGH
LUTHERAN HOSPITAL
SCHOOL OF NURSING,
ST. LOUIS 18, MO.
HOME No. 2

Dec. 18, 1944
England

Dearest Martha,

I received a letter from you yesterday. I was late at night when I got the letter. So I read it in bed. I like to read letters in the bed. as if you get a nice letter like yours it is good. Because then you can have a lot of nice dreams. And you really can write the letters. So I will have nice dreams. And when you have that nice smell with them it is really good.

We are having a heavy fog today. I guess the trucks will

not go to town tonight. It is not
so cold but the fog is bad. You
can not see more than 20 feet
in front of you. If the sun
will come out it would
break up. But we have not
seen the sun in weeks. It is
getting to be the shortest day in the
year now. I wish I could
see the sun. For as you know
the shortest day in the year is
when the sun is $23\frac{1}{2}$ degrees
south of the equator. You see
I do remember something about
school.

I saw an American football
game in town. It was not like

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the ones we had in high school
but it was still good to me the
game. Of course the English could
not catch on to the game.

Well, Christmas is almost here.
But when you get this letter
it will be in the new year.
I hope that you have a nice
Christmas. I will sure write
you about it.

I got your clipping about the rights
in Piccadilly Circus. I have a
lot to tell you about Piccadilly.
But I better not tell you about
it now. I will some of these days.
That is if you want to hear about
it.

4.
So you go for that Esquire
Magazine. I like the pictures
in that book. How do you like
the girls?

So you do not like the Ladies
Bell Bottoms. Across us I
do not see what ^{good clothes} that is
suit. I am sure rich of it.
I am glad you said that you
did not like the service. I think
but it is better for you to stay out.
Your brother really sound
like he is doing a lot for the
war. My brother is done with
his boot training. And was here
make about Dec. 12. I hope
he had a good time.

So you think I will be home
by Easter. Will you just keep up
my morale by saying things like
that. I would kiss you for one
hour if that is true. I would be
happy if I got home by next Christmas.
I can write here all day about
home. And it is best that I do
not say much about it.
And you can keep writing me
about that so it will keep up
my morale.

So you think that it is bad to
have your Christmas before the
day. Well, I have been better
it like that all along. I got
a couple packages from
mother & my grandmother a
day or so ago.

I will be looking forward
to yours. And write you all
about it.

I guess I do not have any
good joke for you. But we
did have a good time. One
of the boys got a jar of jam
from home. It had a spring
on the inside so when you would
take the lid off. It would
jump out at you. We had
good time; you should see the
boys jump.

I miss you very much. I guess
it's true about "this makes the
heart grow fonder."

With All my Love
Willie